

User could not connect Telegram — wedged listener after key revocation

Incident report · TScopier worker (prod listener) · 2026-09-09

SEVERITY	Medium	STATUS	Mitigated — fix awaiting deploy
DATES	Linked 2026-09-08 05:41 UTC; connection lost 2026-09-08 10:58 UTC; self-cleared 2026-09-09 ~07:14 UTC	AFFECTED	1 user — simofiore16321@gmail.com (8491f3f9-ee04-4870-bb93-05fb4bccb856)
COMPONENT	worker/src/sessionManager.ts , worker/src/userListener.ts (prod listener deployment 0a560378)	ROOT CAUSE	Telegram revoked the auth key; the pre-fix worker could not reconnect or stop the listener (reconnect-storm bugs)

1. Executive summary (plain English)

A user who linked her Telegram account on the morning of September 8 was able to copy signals normally for about five hours. Then Telegram suddenly stopped recognising her login (a background security key was revoked), so her account went offline. When the system tried to reconnect her, our worker software on production got stuck — it kept trying but could never reconnect, and it could not be cleanly stopped either. From then on, every attempt she made to reconnect — clicking “Reconnect”, requesting a new code, or using the QR code — timed out and failed.

Nothing she did caused this. The software bug that trapped her was already known and had a written fix, but that fix was not yet running on production. About a day later the stuck background process cleared itself on its own, releasing her account. She is able to connect again with a fresh login. The permanent fix is still waiting to be deployed to production.

2. Issue encountered

- User simofiore16321@gmail.com reported she could not connect (reconnect) her Telegram account.
- Investigation of production Railway logs for her user id (8491f3f9) and the prod DB showed the full chain: a clean link, then a Telegram-side key revocation, then a listener that flapped “disconnected but renewing lease anyway” every ~20 seconds for over 20 hours, during which every reconnect or new-login request timed out after ~90 seconds (AUTH_OPERATION_TIMEOUT).

3. Affected user(s)

ACCOUNT (EMAIL)	SUPABASE ID	TELEGRAM ID	PHONE	LINKED (UTC)	SESSION / CLAIM STATE
simofiore16321@gmail.com	8491f3f9-...b856	7480332791	+39 — (masked)	2026-09-08 05:41:04	session gone ; claim intact

No trades were affected — the copier had not opened positions for this user before the connection was lost. This incident is about the Telegram link itself.

4. Root cause

The trigger (specific to this user): At 2026-09-08 10:58:27 UTC Telegram started rejecting every request from her session with 401 AUTH_KEY_UNREGISTERED — Telegram had revoked/deactivated her auth key. This was isolated to her at that moment (not a multi-user wave), and no duplicate session was detected from our side or any other worker, so it was a Telegram-side key revocation.

Why she could not recover (the bug): The production worker was running a pre-fix build (deployment 0a560378 , built 2026-09-04). Two known bugs in that build — the same family as the 2026-09-07 reconnect-storm incident — meant a listener whose key had died could never heal or be stopped:

- sessionManager.ts — the disconnectedRenewTicks counter (the escape hatch that hard-restarts a stuck listener after ~60s) was deleted every renewal tick, so it never accumulated and the restart never fired (Bug A).
- userListener.ts — forceReconnect’s client.connect() had no timeout, and stop() awaited the in-flight reconnect forever, so reconnect and stop both wedged; the lease was renewed forever, blocking any other worker from taking the user over (Bug B).

5. The fix

- The code fix for both bugs already exists on the staging branch (commit 1ecb9e47 , 2026-09-08): the heal counter now accumulates across disconnected ticks, and every connect/disconnect/stop step is wrapped in a timeout (withTelegramTimeout / TELEGRAM_CONNECT_TIMEOUT_MS) so nothing can wedge forever.
- It has **not** been merged/deployed to production, which is why this user hit it.

6. Timeline (UTC)

TIME (UTC)	EVENT
09-08 05:37:31	Account created and email confirmed.
09-08 05:40–05:41	Phone-code login. Two failed code requests (wrong number format), then success: send_code OK (delivery=app), code verified 05:41:04 as Telegram user 7480332791 (Italian number), 20 channels, session persisted, listener started.
09-08 05:41–10:58	Listener connected and healthy (probes OK). Dispatched a signal at 06:01:20 — the copier worked.
09-08 10:58:27	401 AUTH_KEY_UNREGISTERED on all requests — Telegram revoked the auth key (isolated to this user).
09-08 10:59:09	Watchdog (2 failed probes) triggers force reconnect; connect attempt hits a malformed RPC result and never reconnects (connected=false from here).
09-08 10:59:23	Flapping begins: “listener disconnected but renewing lease anyway” every ~20s, continuously.
09-08 12:44:58	Health row freezes: shutdown_in_progress=true , listener_stop_requested .
09-08 12:45/12:46/12:50	User clicks “Reconnect”: each logs “stopping listener (attempt 1/4)” and never advances — stop is wedged.
09-08 22:48	User clicks “Send a new code”: hangs, then AUTH_OPERATION_TIMEOUT after ~90s; ~8 retries rejected as duplicate_in_flight . “stopping listener” spam until 09-09 06:52.
09-09 06:35 / 06:40	Phone-code and QR login attempts both time out after ~90s.
09-09 ~07:13–07:14	Flapping stops; lease no longer renewed; lease expires 07:14:22. Worker (same deployment) stays alive serving other users. The wedged listener clears itself.
09-09 current	No active listener, no session, lease expired, account claim intact — user can reconnect with a fresh login.

7. Files changed / relevant

- worker/src/sessionManager.ts — Bug A (heal counter). Fix already on staging.

- worker/src/userListener.ts — Bug B (timeouts on connect/disconnect/stop). Fix already on staging.
- worker/src/telegramAuthRecovery.ts — related auth-error handling. Fix already on staging.
- Scratchpad: docs/scratchpads/scratchpad-telegram-connect-simofiore16321-2026-09-09.md (gitignored, local).

8. Verification

- Confirmed the full failure chain in production Railway logs (filter 8491f3f9) and the prod DB.
- Confirmed the running deployment (0a560378 , 09-04) predates the fix and is still alive and serving other users normally.
- Confirmed the current clean state: telegram_sessions empty, telegram_auth_pending empty, lease expired 09-09 07:14, account claim intact.

9. Deployment status & follow-ups

Immediate: A production restart of TScopier - Listener (same image) was done to clear any residual wedged listeners; the affected user can retry a fresh QR/phone login now.

Permanent: The reconnect-storm fix (commit 1ecb9e47) is on staging and must be merged and deployed to the production worker so this class of failure cannot recur.

- Deploy the worker fix (1ecb9e47) to production (listener + trade worker).
- After deploy, watch the 09-07/08 affected users (af75b63e , 30c3fa79 , 494bdb70 , dd18ad68 , 995e7936 , 7fd2f7b4 , and 8491f3f9) for a clean reconnect.